

Money comes to the fore in mayor’s race

Record spending likely for fiery Boston contest

By Emma Platoff and Niki Griswold
GLOBE STAFF

There is no shortage of issues to debate in this year’s Boston mayor’s race: housing, schools, renovations to White Stadium, ever-controversial bike lanes.

But so far, the one that seems to be taking center stage is money — who’s giving it, who’s

spending it, whose dad has a lot of it, and how much of it is funding attack ads.

An outside super PAC aligned with mayoral challenger Josh Kraft has announced it will spend at least \$2.4 million on attack ads against Mayor Michelle Wu. And Kraft, a longtime nonprofit leader and the son of billionaire Patriots owner Robert Kraft, is loaning himself \$2 million. These are just the latest developments in a race that has grown increasingly focused not just on campaign

CAMPAIGN, Page A6



MICHELLE WU

\$919,000 raised so far for current campaign; reported raising \$2.6 million in 2021

JOSH KRAFT

Loaned his campaign \$2 million while outside PAC pledges \$2.4 million in ads

Trump vs. Harvard fight gets personal

White House wants Garber out as school girds for long slog, changes

By Mike Damiano and Hilary Burns
GLOBE STAFF

Two months into their battle against Harvard, Trump officials are making clear the hits won’t stop unless the most visible faces of the school’s resistance are pushed out.

With talks between the gov-

One Trump official, who spoke on condition of anonymity because they were not authorized to speak on behalf of the White House, said Harvard needs to remove its president, Alan Garber, and the school’s senior board member, Penny Pritzker, if it hopes to negotiate a deal.

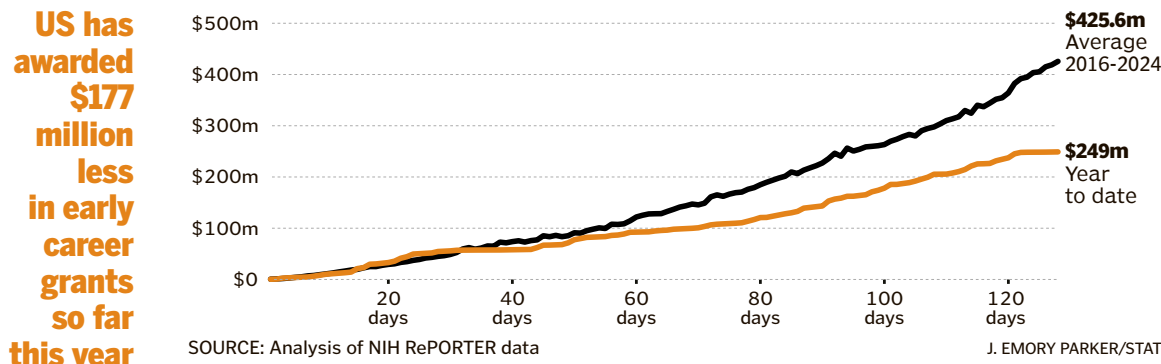
And on Thursday, White House spokesperson Harrison Fields criticized Garber for his

HARVARD, Page A13



DAVID L. RYAN/GLOBE STAFF

Becks Padrusch placed materials in an incubator at UMass Memorial Medical Center in Worcester.



The number of new NIH grant awards for early career researchers has, since the start of the year, plummeted by 43%.

LAB-GROWN PROMISES, BROKEN

Crucial to New England’s future, young scientists are questioning career choices amid federal cuts

By Chris Serres
GLOBE STAFF

and J. Emory Parker
STAT

Becks Padrusch’s fondest memories growing up were of trips to Boston’s Museum of Science, where the Arlington native got to touch animal organs and watch with fascination as chickens hatched in incubators. As a toddler, Padrusch, who uses they/ them pronouns, insisted on bedtime stories about the solar system and how the planets formed.

By age 5, Padrusch knew they wanted to be a scientist.

So Padrusch felt overjoyed when they received an offer to work at a UMass Chan Medical School genetics laboratory, studying how organisms evolve and react to molecules. “It felt like paradise,” said Padrusch, a research associate at the Worcester lab. “I felt that same sense of wonder that I did as a child.”

Now, amid massive cuts to scientific research, Padrusch feels those dreams slipping away. On May 2, their 26th birthday, a lab supervisor gently pulled Padrusch aside and suggested they look for other jobs because of the precarious path ahead for scientific research.

SCIENTISTS, Page A14

For stolen Dutch art, the clue was an \$18 throw pillow

By Malcolm Gay
GLOBE STAFF

WORCESTER — On a balmy Wednesday in early May, Clifford Schorer arrived at the Worcester Art Museum in his 2012 Prius. A tall man with intense eyes, he fished a rectangular package from the rear of the car and bounded up the museum’s new granite steps.

Schorer, a former president of the museum’s board, is a brilliant, some would say brilliantly complex, aficionado, an international art dealer and sleuth who spends his days (and many

nights) hunting “sleepers” — lost masterpieces whose true identities have been obscured through the ages.

Schorer had flown from Brussels the day before with the painting he now carried in his hands, a winter scene by the acclaimed Dutch Golden Age artist Hendrick Avercamp.

The artwork was stolen nearly half a century earlier in a sensational 1978 heist from the baronial estate of Helen and Robert Stoddard, a Worcester industrialist. The Avercamp picture,

PAINTING, Page A8



The Avercamp piece was reproduced on a pillow.

For decades, the chronically underfunded and crumbling MBTA resisted even modest fixes. Enter Phil Eng. **Globe Magazine.**

Local immigrant groups are reeling from the Supreme Court decision allowing President Trump to end, for now, a form of protection. **B1.**

Sunday, sun day

VOL. 307, NO. 152

Suggested retail price \$6.00

Sunday: Clouds and sun. High 64-69, low 50-55.

Monday: Lots of sun. High 68-73, low 54-59.

Complete report, **A22.**

Obituaries, **A21.**

0 9 4 7 7 2 6 1 21716

GET UP TO **\$450**

when you open a Premier Checking Account and qualify*

OR GET UP TO **\$300**

when you open an eZ Checking or Free Checking* Account and qualify*

OFFER ENDS: JUNE 23, 2025

Eastern Bank

JOIN US FOR GOOD®

Learn more at **EasternBank.com/CheckingOffers**

*A minimum opening deposit of \$25 is required for Eastern Free Checking, \$50 for Eastern eZ Checking or \$500 for an Eastern Premier Checking account. To qualify for the incentive, you must open an Eastern Bank personal checking account between 05/17/25 and 06/23/25, and have two or more recurring electronic payroll, pension or government benefits direct deposits totaling the amounts noted in the table below post to your new checking account within the first 90 calendar days of the account opening date. Electronic credits (other than payroll, pension, or government benefits) such as person-to-person payments, self-initiated transfers between your accounts at Eastern Bank and other institutions or brokerages (including pension accounts), and payments through third parties such as PayPal or eBay do not qualify as a direct deposit. Incentive amount will vary. The amount of the incentive paid will be based on the total amount of two or more qualifying direct deposits posted to your account within the first 90 calendar days of the account opening date and the type of account. For cumulative qualifying direct deposits to an Eastern Premier Checking account totaling between \$1,000-3,999.99 incentive will be \$350; for cumulative qualifying direct deposits to an Eastern Premier Checking account totaling \$4,000 or more incentive will be \$450. For cumulative qualifying direct deposits to all other consumer checking accounts totaling between \$1,000-3,999.99, incentive will be \$200; for cumulative qualifying direct deposits to all other consumer checking accounts totaling \$4,000 or more, incentive will be \$300. This offer is valid for new consumer checking account customers only. New customers are primary signers on the new account who have not had a consumer checking account with Eastern Bank, or any bank merged into Eastern Bank, since May 17, 2024. Ninety (90) calendar days after the account open date, we will confirm the type of account to determine the incentive amount and ensure the following requirements are met (if the 90th calendar day falls on a non-business day, the requirements must be met on the following business day): (a) Primary signer must reside in MA, NH, ME or RI; (b) Primary signer must be age 18 or older; (c) Primary signer must have a valid tax ID; (d) Account must be open and have a positive available balance; (e) Premier Checking accounts must meet additional eligibility requirements.† Incentives for qualified accounts will be deposited into customer’s account on or before October 31, 2025 as long as the account is open at the time of the incentive payout. The Bank may, at its discretion, pay the incentive earlier if all the qualifying requirements have been met. Only one incentive per customer and one incentive per household as defined by a common address. Customer will receive a 1099 form for this incentive. Please consult your tax advisor regarding the tax implications of this offer. Other qualifications and restrictions may apply.†Premier Checking \$25,000 combined balance requirement is determined as of the most recent statement cycle prior to the 90th day after the account open date. Premier Checking accounts that do not meet Premier eligibility will receive \$200 or \$300 incentive (as applicable) if they meet all other requirements of the offer. Please refer to the Personal Deposit Account Fees schedule for details regarding the combined balance requirement. †No minimum balance. No monthly fees. Other fees may apply.